

Conversation #19

CONVERSATION

DIFFICULT CONVERSATIONS – COMMUNICATING UNDER PRESSURE IN HEALTHCARE

Prepare 8 pieces of paper numbered from 1 to 8 and have each student draw one to discover their character.

This activity focuses on **difficult conversations, empathy, tone control, and conflict resolution**.

It's **Thursday afternoon** at **VitaCare Saúde Integrada**, São Paulo.

After the recent system outage, internal tension is still high.

Employees are frustrated, some departments feel blamed, and communication has become defensive.

Leadership decided to hold a **cross-department alignment meeting** to address complaints, clarify expectations, and rebuild trust.

This is not a technical meeting — it's about **how people talk, listen, and respond under pressure**.

Internal Communication Data

Issue	Reported Cases (Last 7 Days)
Internal complaints	19
Conflicts between departments	7
Missed handovers	11
Escalations to leadership	5
Employee sick leave requests	6

Student Coaching – How to Use the Information

- Use the data to **express frustration respectfully**
- Practice **softening language** without avoiding the issue
- React emotionally, but professionally
- Focus on **solutions and communication improvements**

Characters

1. Eduardo – Operations Director

"I called this meeting because I can feel the tension everywhere. People are talking *about* each other instead of *to* each other.

I want honesty, but I won't accept disrespect.

If communication doesn't improve, performance won't either.

This conversation is uncomfortable — but necessary."

2. Paula – IT Infrastructure Manager

“Since the outage, it feels like IT is the villain. Everyone points at us, but no one listens when we raise risks.

I’m tired of being defensive. I want clearer communication, not last-minute blame.

If nothing changes, this will happen again.”

3. Ricardo – Clinic Operations Manager

“My team is exhausted. They were yelled at by patients and pressured by leadership at the same time.

We needed support, not silence. I’m here to say that communication failed — badly.

I don’t want apologies. I want alignment.”

4. Fernanda – Patient Experience Director

“I hear both sides — staff frustration and patient anger. But when communication breaks, patients feel abandoned.

We need empathy, not just efficiency. Tone matters as much as content.

If we don’t fix how we talk, we lose trust.”

5. Helena – Finance Director

“From my side, conversations became emotional instead of factual. That creates confusion and bad decisions.

I’m not against emotion — but it needs structure. Clear messages save time and money.

I want communication that supports decisions, not chaos.”

6. Marcos – Compliance & Legal Advisor

“Words create risk. One careless message can become a lawsuit.

During the outage, some communications worried me. We need boundaries, even under pressure.

I’m here to protect the organization — and the people.”

7. Thiago – Medical Director

“Doctors felt ignored. They needed information, not excuses.

Clinical teams depend on trust and clarity. When communication fails, patient safety is at risk.

I won’t let this happen again.”

8. Luana – HR & Communication Facilitator

“My role is not to take sides. It’s to help people speak — and listen — better.

This meeting is about learning, not blaming.

If we leave without agreements, we failed.

I will guide the next steps.”

Title: _____

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